VOLUNTARY · ROUGH BOARDS

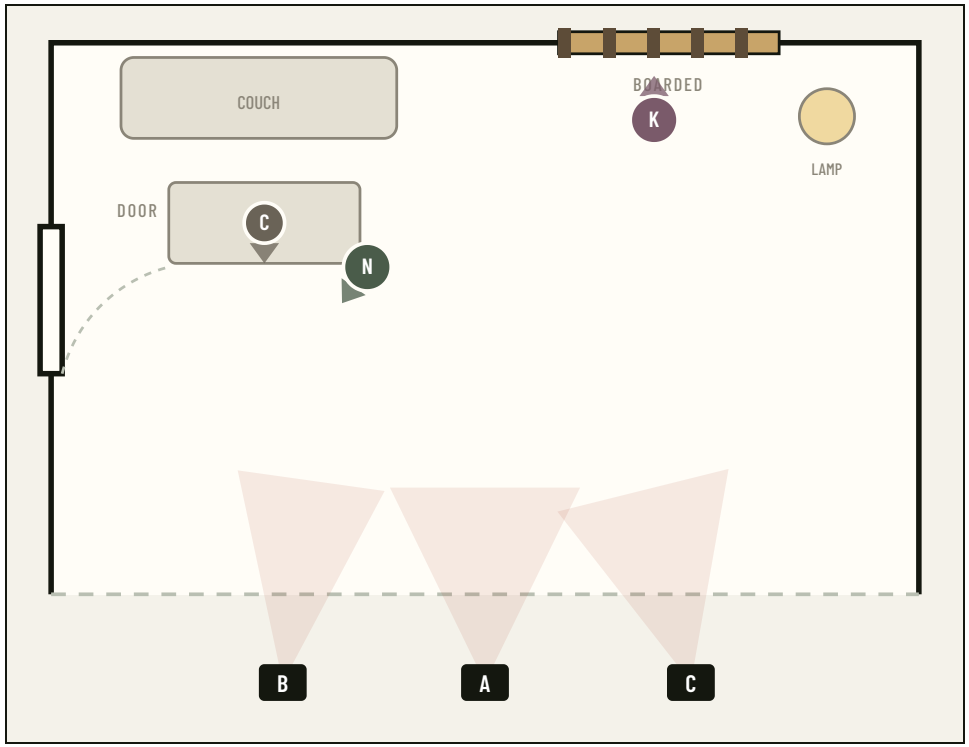
Main sketch. Composed for horizontal. The vertical window shows where 9:16 would be pulled from.

4 floor plans + 16 frames · 16:9 with 9:16 crop shown

Josh Peters · josh@nfa.studio

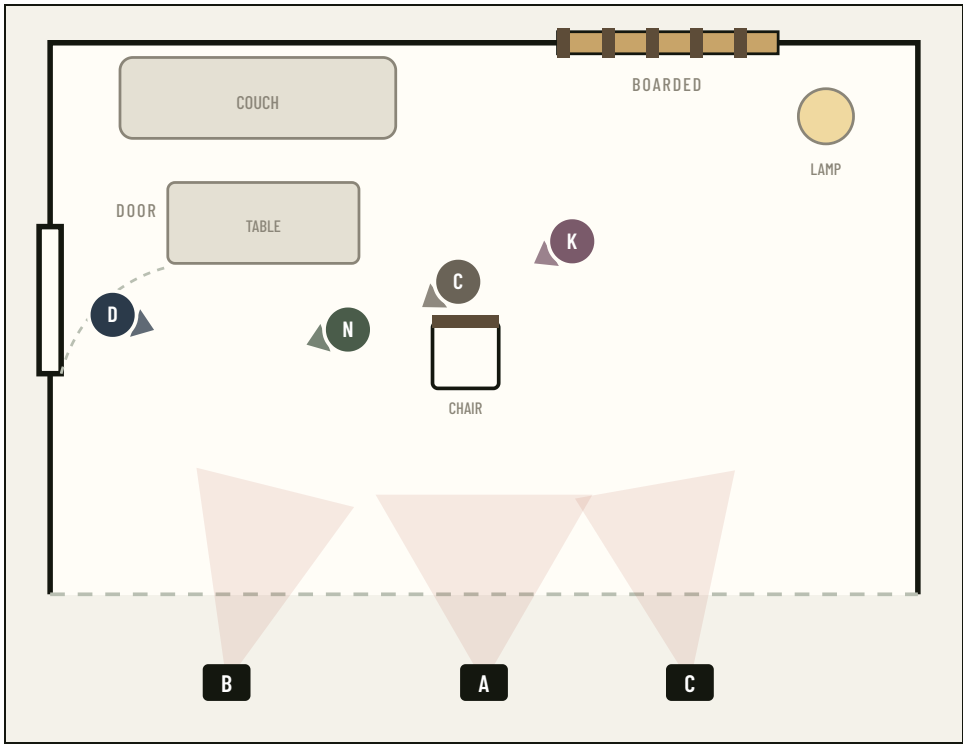
KEY Terry · Dean · Cristian · Nyla · Cathy · crop it · extra take · split screen

Plan 1 · Cold open



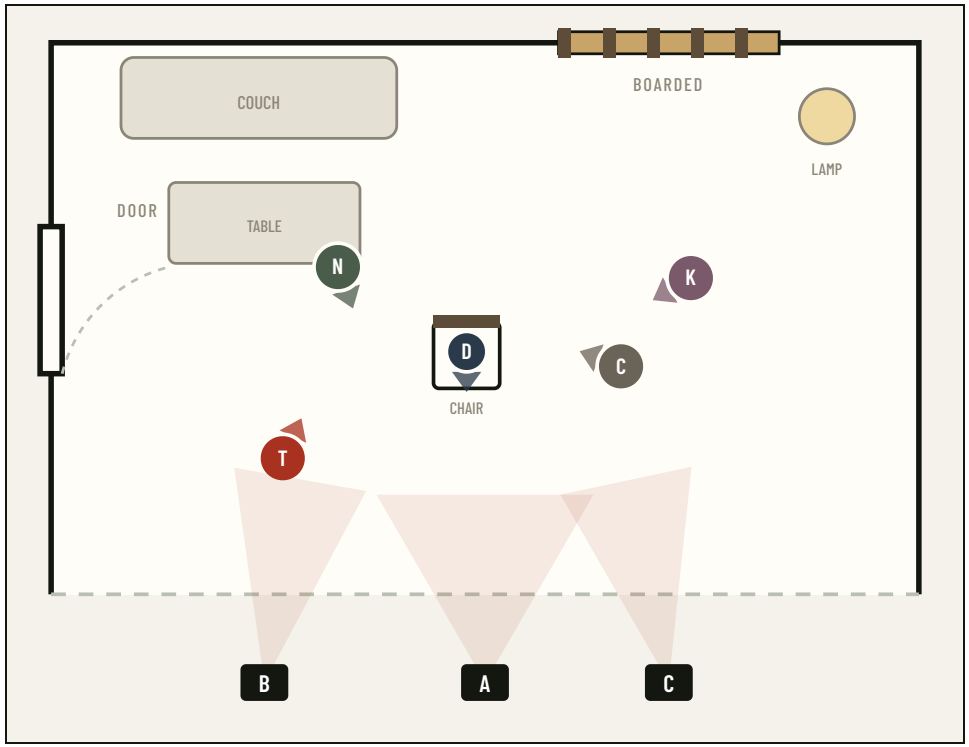
Cristian on the coffee table, Nyla working. Cathy upstage at the boards with her back to them. Nobody knows Dean is about to come through that door.

Plan 2 · The burst-in



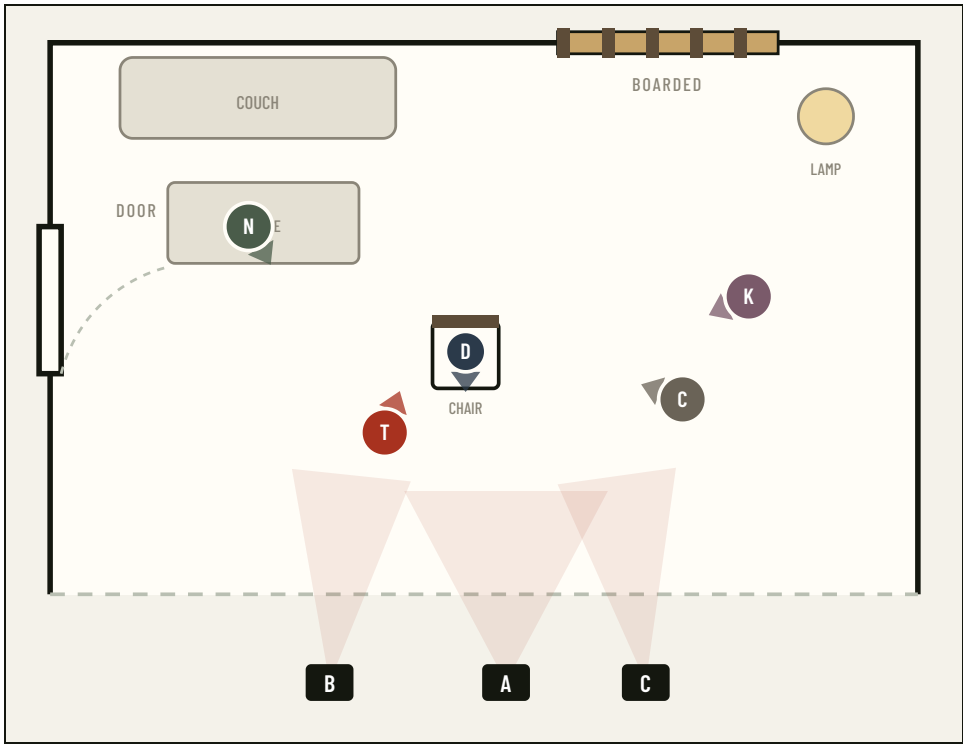
Dean through the door, stage left. Everyone turns on him, which naturally opens them out to camera. He gets walked to the chair.

Plan 3 · The volunteer



Dean tied, chair centre. Terry steps downstage-left out of the group, which puts him in the left third of A and gives B a clean single on him.

Plan 4 · The approach and the reveal

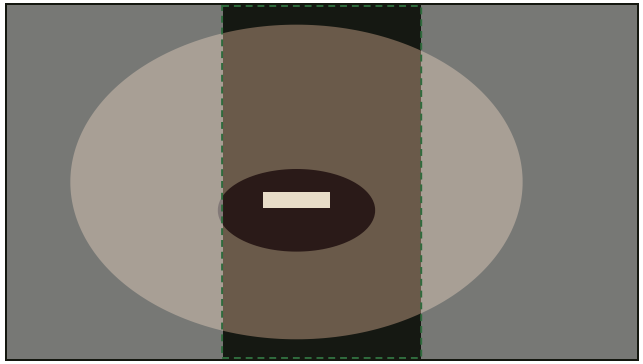


Terry closes to a foot. The others give ground, which clears the two-shot. Do not cross behind the chair or Dean loses camera.

CAMERA POSITIONS A is the locked master, roughly centre. B works the left, C works the right. All three roll every take. Nobody crosses the line behind the chair, so Dean always faces camera and Terry always comes at him from frame left.

1. COLD OPEN

CAM A

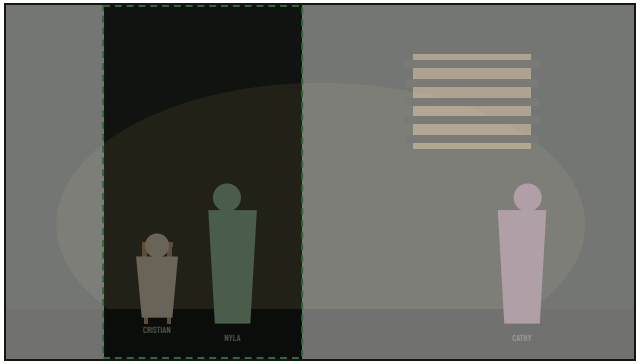


Extreme CU. The gaps either side of his front teeth. First image of the piece.

- VERTICAL: CROP IT

2. COLD OPEN, WIDE

CAM C

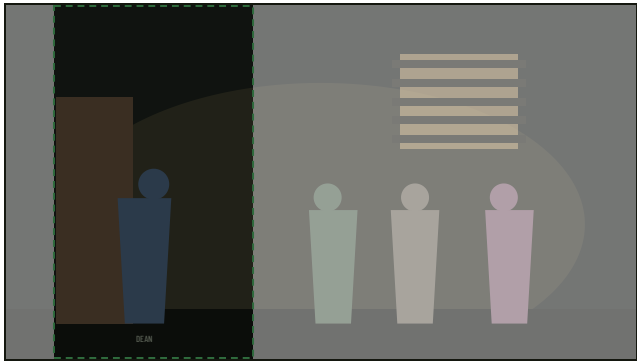


Nyla working on Cristian, weighted left. Cathy right third at the boards. Vertical pulls off the pair.

- VERTICAL: CROP IT

3. THE BURST-IN

CAM A

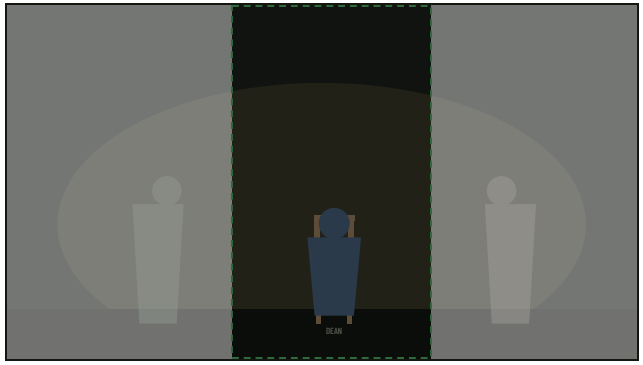


Door left third, Dean through it. Group holds the right. Vertical is Dean in the doorway.

- VERTICAL: CROP IT

4. INTO THE CHAIR

CAM B

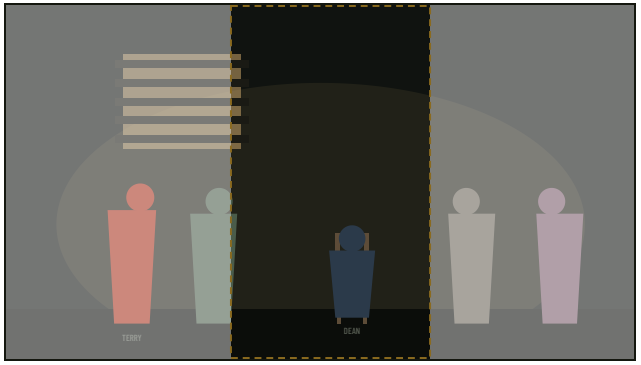


Handheld, follows him down. He fills enough of frame that the crop is free.

- VERTICAL: CROP IT

5. TIED

CAM A

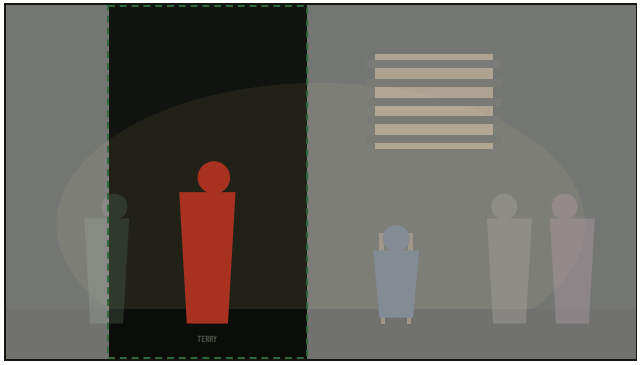


The geography shot. Dean off-centre, group spread. Horizontal only. Grab a tighter pass on Dean for vertical.

◉ VERTICAL: GRAB AN EXTRA TAKE

6. "I'LL DO IT."

CAM A

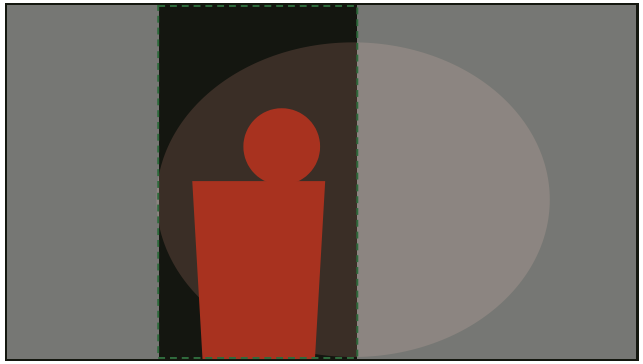


Terry steps out of the group into the left third. Everyone turns. Vertical sits on him.

- VERTICAL: CROP IT

7. "I ACTUALLY HATE HIM"

CAM B

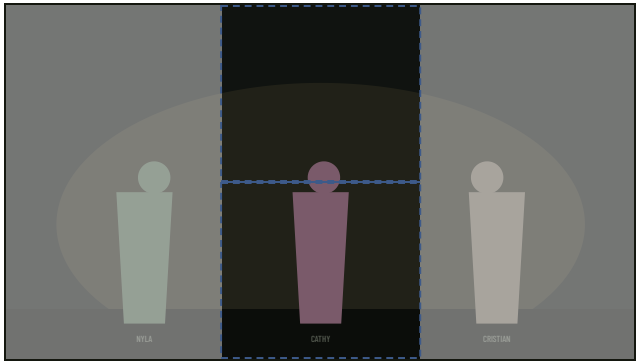


Terry off-centre with room to his eyeline. He fills the crop on his own.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

8. THE ROOM TAKES IT

CAM C

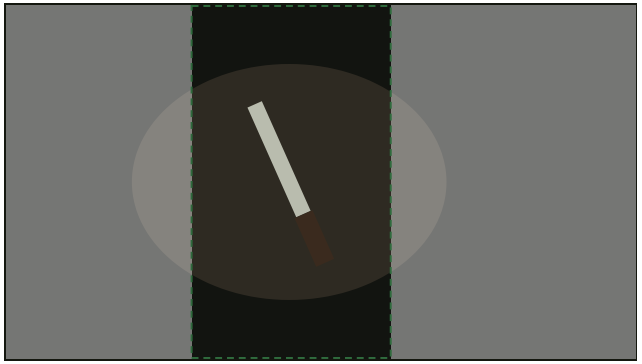


Three across. Never crops. This is the split screen: Terry top from B, the three of them bottom from C.

■ VERTICAL: SPLIT SCREEN

9. THE KNIFE

CAM C

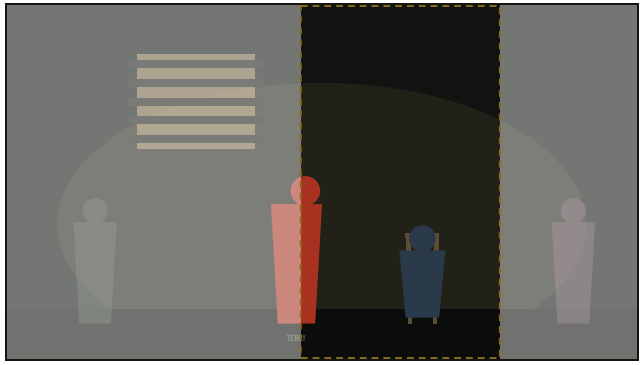


Insert. He turns it over and wipes it down his jeans, which makes it worse.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

10. THE APPROACH

CAM A

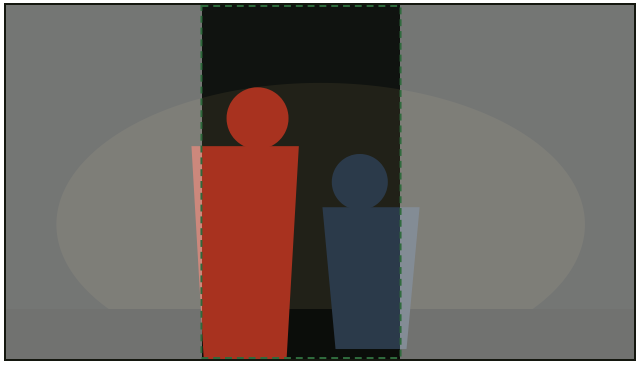


Terry crosses right to left. Wide, so the vertical is not in here. Extra take tight on the two of them as he arrives.

◉ VERTICAL: GRAB AN EXTRA TAKE

11. A FOOT AWAY

CAM B

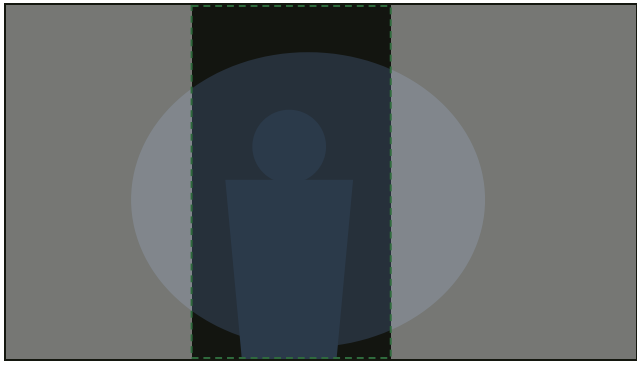


Two-shot, stacked rather than side by side. Crops without losing either of them.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

12. THE SPIRAL

CAM A

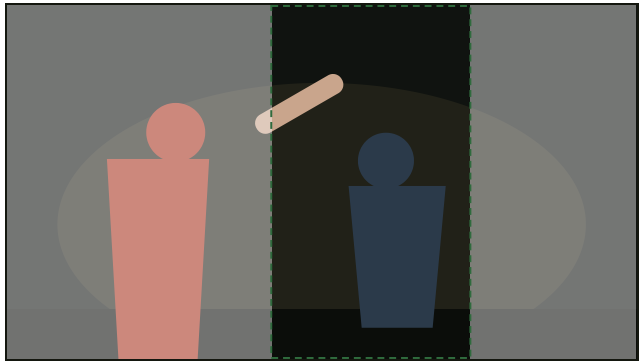


Dean tight, the whole run. Let him go long. He fills the crop.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

13. ARM COMES LOOSE

CAM A

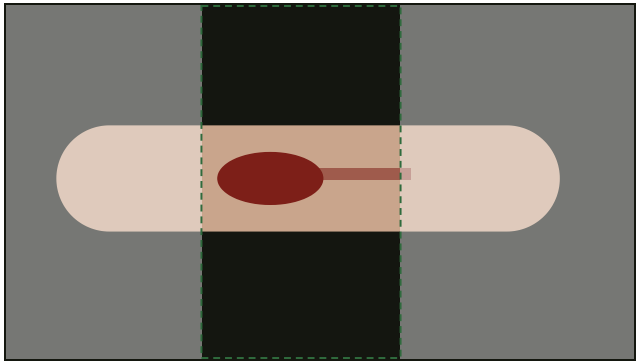


Dean right, arm swinging up past Terry. Vertical pulls right, onto the arm and Dean.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

14. THE SMEAR

CAM B

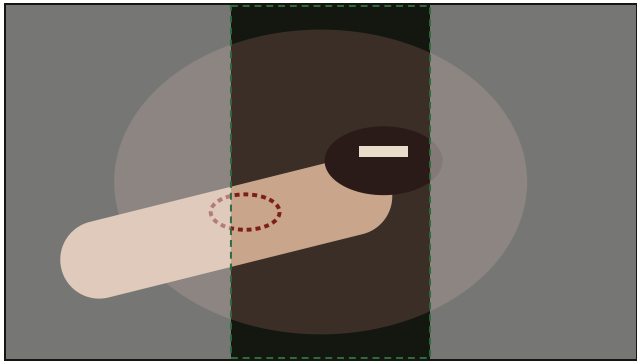


Insert. Dragged sideways, too much of it, wipeable. The first clue.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

15. TEETH ALIGN

CAM C

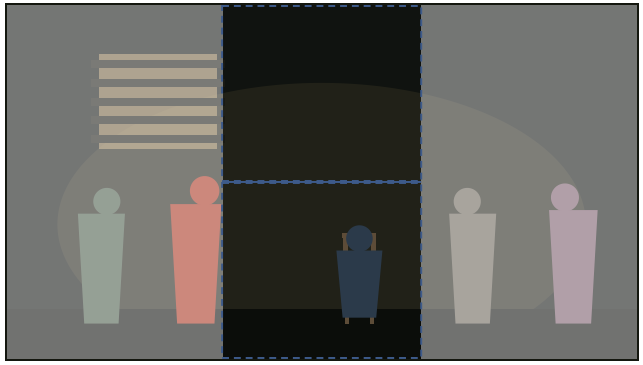


Insert. Arm lifted to his own mouth, the two gaps sitting over the marks. Shoot twice.

● VERTICAL: CROP IT

16. THE BLOWUP

CAM A



Everyone on everyone. Never crops. Split it: whoever has the line on top, the chair on the bottom.

■ VERTICAL: SPLIT SCREEN